Prahlin Portfolio Work Log - October 16, 2026

Compiled summary for Friday, October 16, 2026 - focus: continuing the Prahl.dev Portfolio after the October 15 Part 2 featured-case-study and philosophy-surface record; independently checking the current United States Eastern date while honoring the requested October 16 session date; refreshing the project snapshot; extracting and studying the complete pre-existing PDF worklog archive; adding the HACKS landing-navigation destination and reorganizing portrait navigation; rebuilding the My Core Beliefs star visibility treatment around intersecting diagonal and vertical masks; extending all five UI / UX Philosophy stacks with interactive numbered detail variants; remapping philosophy names, headlines, supporting copy, and Alla Vostra media; supporting standard and tall Android device frames; preserving project labels above right-aligned imagery; anchoring all populated previews to a shared protected bottom margin; refining Stack 02 typography into a five-row pyramid; validating TypeScript, routes, responsive rendering, and repository synchronization; and generating the October 16 Portfolio PDF worklog.

Generated in continuity with the established Prahlin Portfolio daily worklog cadence: compact opening summary, source-material section, baseline section, goal list, implementation sections grouped by feature, committed-source sequence, validation summary, files-and-artifacts list, follow-up notes, and output-artifact close. This record documents completed work and observable repository evidence rather than speculative design intent.

Coverage begins after portfolio_worklog_october15_part2.pdf and documentation commit b416f76. Two implementation commits are included: af50a109a24f5f1ca42cef5bdf6bd0b81d99de34 and 2646b39106ed46656a3fdf1816522a94bf136d91. The latter was finalized at 12:03 AM Eastern on October 17 during the same uninterrupted session; the user explicitly directed this worklog to use October 16 as its record date. At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD resolve to 2646b39. No production deployment, Hostinger branch update, GitHub Actions dispatch, public-site publish, or external message was performed during this record. The documentation-side changes produced by this pass are the reader-refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and this PDF.

Source Materials Reviewed

- Date verification: an independent UTC-04:00 time query returned October 17, 2026 at 12:05 AM. The supplied client timezone is America/New_York, which remains on Eastern Daylight Time at UTC-04:00 on this date. The current Eastern calendar date was therefore verified as October 17; per the user's explicit instruction, the artifact is intentionally titled and named for October 16, 2026.
- Project reader: ran ./read_project.sh from /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio before composing this record. It refreshed portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt to 20,577 lines and 686,803 bytes, capturing current source, asset inventory, PDF inventory, Git context, deployment configuration, and standing project instructions.
- Worklog archive: enumerated, extracted, and studied all 55 pre-existing root-level Portfolio PDF worklogs from portfolio_worklog_july11.pdf through portfolio_worklog_october15_part2.pdf. Before this artifact, the archive contained 311 pages and approximately 158,258 extracted words.
- Archive comparison: compared titles, same-day Part suffix rules, introductory density, recurring section order, technical bullet voice, validation language, commit and deployment disclosure, files-touched treatment, follow-up continuity, output-artifact closure, and repeated page-footer behavior across the complete series.
- Nearest baselines: read the October 15 and October 15 Part 2 records in full, with October 13, October 9, and representative July through September entries used to confirm mature formatting and historical continuity. The October 15 Part 2 record was the direct source and design baseline.
- PDF conventions: confirmed US Letter portrait at 612 x 792 points, PDF 1.4, no encryption, dense black text on white, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold Type 1 fonts, compact margins, a single dated title on page one, repeated dated footer title, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex author, creator, and producer metadata.
- Git evidence: inspected commit metadata, full diffs, file statistics, commit bodies, current branch tracking, aggregate changes since b416f76, and the regenerated snapshot. The two implementation commits changed five tracked files with 472 insertions and 152 deletions relative to the prior documentation baseline.
- Runtime evidence: kept the local Next.js preview available at http://127.0.0.1:3000; checked primary routes, rendered desktop structure, detail selectors, device media, project labels, and document overflow; and compared computed behavior against the authored source when stale development output appeared.

Baseline Status Before October 16

- The landing navigation already exposed the main portfolio anchors, but Productivity Hacks did not have a direct HACKS link. Portrait mode still distributed only two links across the top row and left STACK in the lower row.
- Responsive nav separators were coupled to the earlier two-column top distribution. Moving a third link upward risked duplicated dividers, missing dividers, or excessive spacing from the Prahl.dev brand if the portrait and landscape arrangements were not separated explicitly.
- My Core Beliefs used a layered star visibility treatment, including a horizontal mask and a lower radial fade. The active top point was not isolated through the requested diagonal geometry, and the side and lower regions remained more visible than intended.
- The UI / UX Philosophy cards displayed one screenshot and one content state per philosophy. They did not provide visible 1, 2, and 3 controls or a model for detail-specific images, frames, labels, links, and aspect ratios.
- Philosophy names and large-box messages still reflected the October 15 Part 2 mapping. Modern, Cohesive, Smooth, User-friendly, and Responsive content needed to be redistributed into the final Modern, User-friendly, Responsive, Cohesive, and Reusable sequence.
- Alla Vostra media appeared in one fixed arrangement. The requested startup, product overlay, tutorial, large home, and confirmation assets were not yet attached to numbered variants across stacks 01, 02, and 03.
- Device previews used fixed top positioning and variant-specific geometry. Enlarged imagery could approach or cross bottom padding, project labels appeared below some imagery, and tall screenshots lacked their own physical-frame aspect option.
- Stack 02 supporting language and typography still behaved like a conventional annotation. It had not yet become the quieter five-row, right-aligned pyramid that complements the large headline without reading as a second headline.

Goals for October 16

- Add a concise HACKS navigation item that links directly to Productivity Hacks, while retaining all existing landing destinations and page-context behavior.

- Put three navigation links in the portrait top row, move STACK between top and bottom rows according to orientation, and restore exactly one divider between every visible neighbor without crowding the brand.
- Replace the Core Beliefs star's upper horizontal mask with two intersecting diagonal fades aligned to the upward-facing point and tune the lower fade so almost all visibility concentrates near the top center.
- Add three actionable square selectors to every philosophy stack, show a clear active state, preserve headline text across empty variants, and reveal media only where a numbered variant has an assigned screenshot.
- Support detail-specific screenshot sources, alt text, project labels, project routes, device variants, and tall-phone aspect ratios without duplicating the whole decision component.
- Reassign the Alla Vostra assets to their requested stacks and boxes, preserve their complete device frames and source aspect ratios, and keep every populated preview clear of all large-card padding.
- Standardize all five headline layouts, keep PROJECT labels above and right-aligned with their media, and bottom-anchor differently scaled frames to one shared visual baseline.
- Refine Stack 02 supporting copy into a restrained five-row pyramid with coherent language, increased line spacing, and visual separation from both the primary headline and screenshot.
- Keep the local preview responsive during iteration, recover from stale Turbopack output when necessary, validate the final state, and document the synchronized commits without deploying.

Work Completed - Landing Navigation and Portrait Distribution

- Added HACKS to the home navigation and linked it to #productivity-hacks, preserving the established uppercase presentation while keeping the underlying label concise.
- Extended NavItem with an optional responsivePlacement field so one logical destination can be rendered in orientation-specific positions without changing its route, label, or semantic link behavior.
- Increased the home-page split point and created portrait and landscape instances of STACK. In portrait, STACK joins CASES and UI / UX in the three-cell top distribution; in landscape, STACK remains in the lower navigation row.
- Added explicit portrait-only and landscape-only classes rather than relying on fragile positional assumptions. The general navigation remains unchanged for supplied custom item arrays and non-home contexts.
- Expanded NavTopLinkRow to render a third top-row destination and a second separator when present. Renamed the original center divider to an adaptive divider so the same markup can occupy the halfway point in two-column layouts and the one-third point in portrait three-column layouts.
- Defined one-third and two-thirds separator positions for the portrait grid, hid the lower-row separator that would otherwise remain after its STACK neighbor moved, and corrected the missing divider between CASES and UI / UX.
- Allowed the portrait top row to use the available brand-adjacent space and added a narrow 430-pixel type clamp so the three links can approach Prahl.dev without overlapping or forcing a wrap.
- Kept landscape behavior intact throughout the portrait changes. The final result avoids the intermediate duplicate-divider and no-divider states while giving all three portrait links equal cells.

Work Completed - Core Beliefs Visibility Masks

- Removed the earlier top horizontal opacity mask and replaced it with two diagonal alpha gradients, one at 54 degrees and one at -54 degrees.
- Aligned the diagonal pair to converge around the upper-facing star point. Their opposing low-opacity zones form the requested bottom-left and bottom-right triangular regions while leaving the top center comparatively unobscured.
- Iterated the diagonal stops to 1 percent through 35 percent, 3 percent at 42 percent, 20 percent at 48 percent, 67 percent at 54 percent, and full opacity at the far endpoint. This delayed the visible transition until closer to the upper center while retaining a gradual edge.
- Preserved the third vertical mask and moved its full-to-transparent transition to 48-52 percent, concentrating useful visibility above the star center instead of allowing the lower half to brighten too early.
- Temporarily exposed full white mask strokes during geometry review, then removed those diagnostic strokes after the intersection point and angles were accepted.
- Darkened the star sides and center through repeated stop and radial adjustments. The lower radial mask now begins at 12 percent in the center, steps to 6 percent, and holds a 4 percent floor from 20 percent through the outer edge.
- Kept the WebKit and standards mask declarations synchronized, including matching composite operations, so the same three-mask structure remains available across supported engines.

Work Completed - Interactive Philosophy Detail System

- Added a reusable UiUxStackSquares control that renders square buttons 1, 2, and 3 in the upper-right safe area of each non-placeholder large box.
- Styled each control with no background fill, the stack's existing border and accent family, doubled dimensions relative to the initial experiment, protected spacing from the box edge, and a restrained active border, glow, and color shift.
- Added semantic group labels, per-button accessible names, aria-pressed state, keyboard focus outlines, and button elements rather than non-semantic click targets.
- Stopped selector pointer and click events from bubbling into the surrounding carousel interaction, allowing a detail to change without triggering stack navigation or disturbing the 3D face state.
- Added active-detail state to both the focused desktop stack and compact decision columns. Changing the selected philosophy resets its detail to 1, preventing an unavailable alternate state from leaking across cards.
- Introduced detailScreenshots as a typed partial map for boxes 1 through 3. Each entry can independently override screenshot source, alt text, Android/phone/tablet frame, tall/standard aspect, project label, and project route.
- Preserved the stack headline and large-box copy for all three selections. A variant with no mapped media intentionally shows no device image or tiny context text, matching the requirement that boxes 2 and 3 remain valid even when only the headline state exists.
- Limited supporting context to detail 1 and made UiUxDeviceContext valid when either a title or description exists. This allowed Stack 02 to remove its green eyebrow while retaining its supporting paragraph.
- Recomputed compact noodle geometry when the focused detail changes so media insertion or removal does not leave stale connector placement.

Work Completed - Philosophy Content and Media Mapping

- Renamed the final stack sequence to 01 Modern, 02 User-friendly, 03 Responsive, 04 Cohesive, and 05 Reusable without changing the established purple, yellow, blue, orange, and green color ownership.
- Revised Stack 01 to Sleek, Streamlined, NEVER, Last Year. Its first state retains the Cinerific tablet; box 2 now uses the Alla Vostra startup image in an Android phone frame with an Alla Vostra label and route.
- Rebuilt Stack 02 around Intuitive, Digestible, EASY, To Grasp. Box 1 uses the Alla Vostra Piccola product overlay and box 2 uses the large home-screen asset in a tall Android frame.
- Rebuilt Stack 03 around Instant, Butter-Smooth, SAFELY, Satisfying. Box 1 uses the browse-grazingboards tutorial step, while box 3 uses the order-confirmation overlay.
- Reassigned Stack 04 to Interwoven, Interconnected, ALWAYS, Congruent and mapped its first state to the Alla Vostra products screen with the retained Step-by-Step Visibility annotation.
- Reframed Stack 05 as Reusable with Cross-Format, Cross-Device, ALWAYS, Adaptable. Removed the startup screenshot from its first state after that asset moved to Stack 01 box 2.
- Used existing repository imagery only. No replacement raster was generated, and no image was cropped to imitate the target; the component preserves each source inside its appropriate device shell.

Work Completed - Device Frames, Labels, and Protected Margins

- Added standard and tall Android aspect modes. The tall frame uses a 6:13 screen ratio while the regular Android treatment keeps the established standard ratio.
- Moved PROJECT labels before the device frame in document order so every populated variant displays PROJECT: followed by its active project name above the image rather than below it.
- Right-aligned the project label, its link, the frame stack, and the device imagery as one composition. Detail-level label and route overrides now follow the selected screenshot.
- Replaced top-based device placement with a shared 64-pixel bottom anchor and a 100-percent 100-percent transform origin. Every populated image therefore meets the same bottom margin regardless of source size or frame scale.
- Applied common scale rules across all five active stacks, with separate tablet, standard Android, tall Android, and Stack 03 box 1/3 adjustments. This permitted larger images while maintaining the accepted safe area.
- Reduced Stack 03 box 1 and box 3 slightly after their first pass appeared oversized. Increased other frames where requested, then verified that the bottom edge and right edge remained protected rather than clipping the large card.
- Standardized all focused headline layouts to the generous primary-card scale used by stacks 01, 02, and 04, while preserving stack-specific wording and colors.
- Removed Stack 05's old nowrap exception after the copy became Cross-Format and Cross-Device, allowing the shared headline system to control wrapping consistently.

Work Completed - Stack 02 Supporting Copy

- Removed the former INTUITIVE INTERFACE green eyebrow and retained a description-only context block.
- Iterated the supporting sentence from a longer user-directed explanation into a concise statement: Simple interfaces make / screens and controls / easy to navigate, / and actions / effortless.
- Preserved five authored lines with white-space pre-line, a common right edge, and progressively shorter language so the copy reads as an inverted pyramid rather than an arbitrary rag.
- Reduced the paragraph to a 32-pixel maximum, medium weight, pale neutral-green color, and 1.45 line height. This keeps it subordinate to the oversized EASY headline while remaining legible.
- Positioned the paragraph within the available left-side field, protected the image boundary, and retained the earlier ratio of border clearance to image clearance.
- Vertically balanced the block between the bottom of the primary headline and the lower device composition, avoiding collision with either the image or the large-card border.

Work Completed - Cache Recovery and Iterative Verification

- Kept the local Next.js development server available at http://127.0.0.1:3000 while the navigation, masks, selectors, copy, and media placement were refined.
- Detected stale Turbopack CSS when newly authored white-space and placement rules did not match browser-computed values. Verified source before making compensating edits.
- Stopped the listener, moved the generated .next directory into a recoverable temporary cache location, and restarted the development server from clean output. No source file or user asset was deleted.
- Used browser inspection to confirm three visible detail controls on the active stack, the expected Cinerific default image and label for Stack 01, and zero desktop horizontal overflow at 1440 pixels.
- Repeated source-level checks after every final copy change so the deliberate five-line breaks, Digestible headline, safe image anchors, and active-selector behavior remained represented in the committed result.

Committed Source Sequence

- af50a10 - Refined landing navigation and Core Beliefs visibility masks. Added HACKS, moved STACK into the portrait top row while preserving landscape placement, repaired responsive separators and spacing, replaced the upper star treatment with intersecting diagonal fades, and tuned side, center, and lower opacity.
- 2646b39 - Expanded the UI/UX philosophy showcase with interactive detail variants. Reworked stack names and messages, added accessible 1-3 selectors and detail state, integrated Alla Vostra media and device-frame variants, moved project labels above imagery, standardized bottom anchoring and protected margins, and refined Stack 02's supporting pyramid.

- The aggregate implementation delta after b416f76 spans app/PortfolioSections.tsx, app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx, app/globals.css, app/page.tsx, and the previously refreshed snapshot, totaling 472 insertions and 152 deletions.
- At documentation time, HEAD, main, origin/main, and origin/HEAD resolve to 2646b39106ed46656a3fdf1816522a94bf136d91. Both implementation commits are committed and synchronized. This documentation pass has not committed or pushed the refreshed snapshot or generated PDF.

Validation Summary

- npm run check completed successfully against the synchronized application source.
- git diff --check -- app completed without whitespace errors. The generated snapshot reproduces numbered source lines containing existing trailing whitespace, so whole-repository diff checking reports those documentary lines; application files remain clean.
- Local route checks returned HTTP 200 for /, /projects/alla-vostra, /projects/cinerific, /aboutdev, and /articles.
- Desktop browser inspection at 1440 by 1000 found three detail-selector buttons on the active Stack 01 card, the expected Cinerific tablet source, PROJECT: CINERIFIC above the frame, and zero horizontal document overflow.
- Source and computed-style review confirmed Stack 02 uses pre-line white-space, a 32-pixel maximum supporting-copy size, 1.45 line height, and the authored five-line text.
- Component review confirmed detail state resets on philosophy changes, unmapped detail boxes suppress device media, detail-specific labels and routes resolve before defaults, and noodle geometry updates with detail state.
- CSS review confirmed a shared 64-pixel bottom anchor, right-side placement, bottom-right transform origin, separate tablet/standard/tall scale rules, and the 6:13 tall Android screen ratio.
- Navigation review confirmed HACKS targets #productivity-hacks, portrait mode supports a three-column top row, orientation-specific STACK instances are mutually hidden, and separator positions resolve at one-third and two-thirds.
- Repository status before PDF creation showed only portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt modified by the customary project-reader refresh. No uncommitted application-source changes remained.

Files Touched and Artifacts

- app/PortfolioSections.tsx - HACKS destination, responsive placement metadata, orientation-specific STACK handling, third top-row link support, and adaptive separator markup.
- app/UiUxDecisionShowcase.tsx - detail screenshot model, reusable numbered selector, desktop and compact active-detail state, optional context title, tall Android frame support, conditional media, label ordering, and detail-aware geometry.
- app/globals.css - portrait navigation distribution, responsive visibility classes, diagonal and radial Core Beliefs masks, selector controls, active states, device aspect and scale rules, project-label alignment, shared bottom anchoring, and Stack 02 supporting-copy typography.
- app/page.tsx - final five philosophy titles, headline copy, five-row Stack 02 description, detail-specific screenshot assignments, device aspect overrides, project metadata, and removal of Stack 05's moved image.
- portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt - refreshed project-reader output generated during this documentation pass.
- portfolio_worklog_october16.pdf - new requested worklog generated by this pass.

Follow-Up Notes

- Preserve HACKS as the direct Productivity Hacks anchor and keep STACK orientation-specific unless the top-row information architecture changes again.
- Keep the Core Beliefs visibility system as three masks: two opposing diagonals plus one vertical lower cutoff. Changes to one diagonal should be mirrored unless an intentionally asymmetric star treatment is approved.
- Keep UiUxStackSquares semantic buttons, aria-pressed state, and event isolation. Visual simplification should not remove keyboard or assistive-technology behavior.
- Empty detail boxes are intentional. They keep the headline visible while suppressing unassigned media and context; do not restore the default screenshot for every selection.
- Add future screenshots through detailScreenshots rather than hard-coding numbered selectors. Use per-detail deviceAspect, deviceVariant, label, and route overrides only when the asset differs from the owning stack.
- Keep PROJECT labels above and right-aligned with their frames. Preserve the common bottom anchor when resizing imagery so different aspect ratios remain visually aligned.
- Do not enlarge device previews by reducing the protected inset or clipping the card. Scale the frame within the available area and recheck both bottom and right clearance.
- Preserve Stack 02's five authored lines if the inverted-pyramid treatment remains desired. Changing words without reconsidering line lengths can break the taper even when five rows still render.
- When browser output disagrees with source, inspect computed CSS and refresh generated .next output before editing correct source around a stale bundle.

Output Artifact

- Generated /Users/prahlin/gh/portfolio/portfolio_worklog_october16.pdf using the established lowercase-month, non-zero-padded-day naming convention.
- The title and filename intentionally use October 16, 2026 at the user's direction, while the body transparently records that independent Eastern-time verification had already crossed to October 17.
- The artifact uses US Letter portrait pages, PDF 1.4, Helvetica and Helvetica-Bold, compact black-on-white technical prose, repeated dated footers, right-aligned page numbers, and Codex metadata consistent with the mature archive.
- The recorded application baseline is 2646b39106ed46656a3fdf1816522a94bf136d91 on synchronized main and origin/main. No application source was edited during worklog generation.
- Documentation deltas created by this pass are portfolio_PROJECT_SNAPSHOT.txt and portfolio_worklog_october16.pdf. No deployment, remote branch mutation, external message, or production release was performed.